2.4 Star and Constellations

A **star** is type of astronomical object which has its own light and heat. The nearest **star** to earth is the Sun. Sirius is brighter star than the sun. 'Proxima Centauri' is the closest star to the sun. Star is formed when enough dust and gas clump together because of the gravitational forces. Star changes its forms during its lifetime such as-red giant, white dwarf, neutron star and black hole.

Constellation (Figure 2.2) is a group of stars that forms a particular shape in the sky. In 1929, the International Astronomical Union (IAU) adopted official constellation boundaries that defined 88 official constellations that

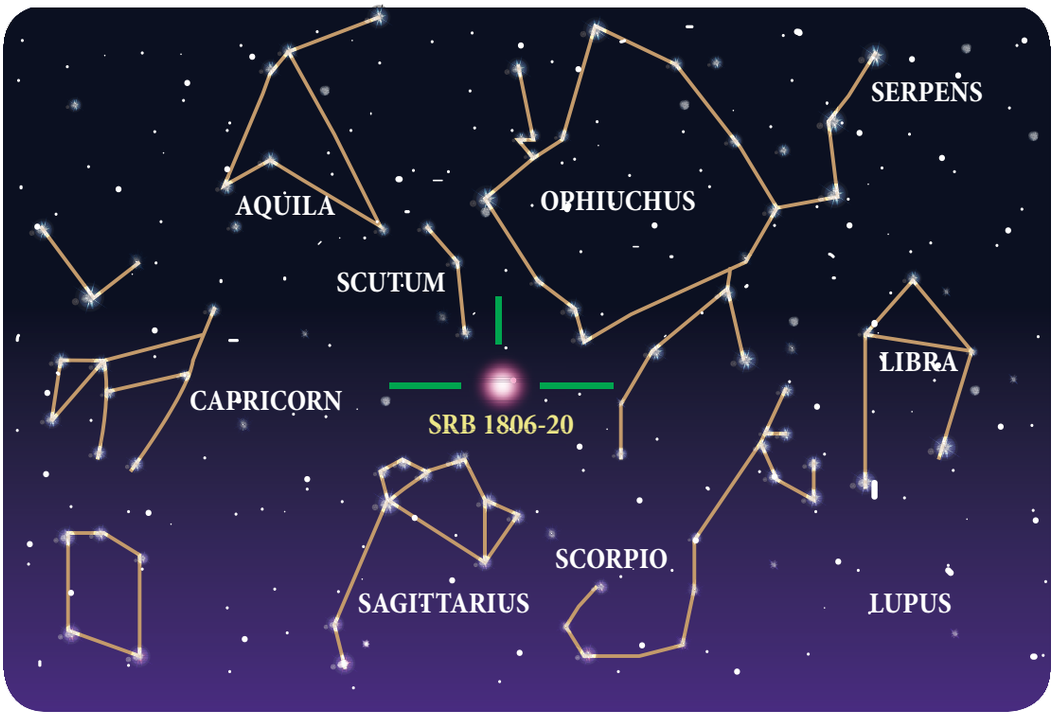


Figure 2.2 Constellation-Sagittarius, like a teapot

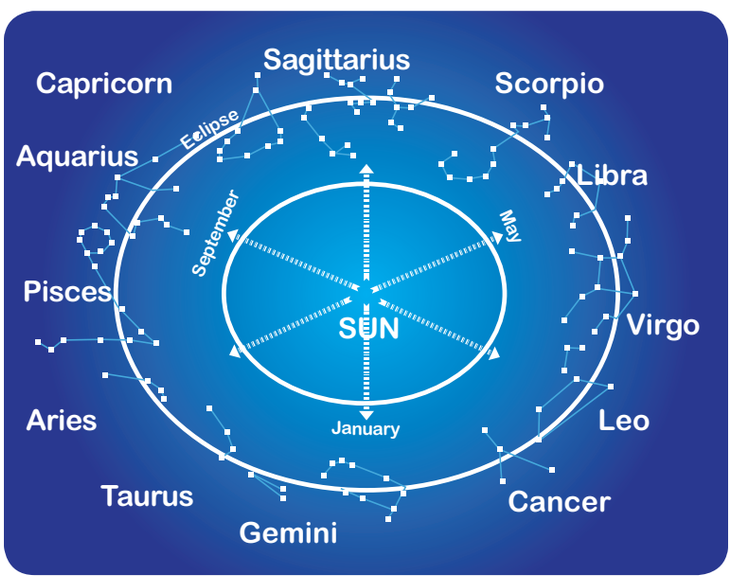


Figure 2.3 Constellation

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